CHASSEUR WEAPONS AND EQUIPMENT

A chasseur on patrol carried a range of weapons, including a cavalry sabre, a carbine, and sometimes a pair of pistols. His principal weapon was the sabre – firearms were of real use only in an emergency as they would take too long to reload in a serious encounter with the enemy. While the cavalryman's weapons obviously played an important part in his role as a skirmisher and a scout, his horse and his tack were also crucial.

Ramrod

Three-barred hilt

Carbine
The cavalryman's carbine was a smoothbore flintlock. This is the An 1X model (made in year nine of the Revolutionary calendar, that is 1801) manufactured at Charleville, the French government armament factory on the Meuse in northeastern France.

Ring to attach sling

Striking steel and open pan cover

Pan

Clamp to hold flint

Sabre and scabbard
French light cavalry liked to thrust with the point of the blade as well as deliver swinging cuts with the edge. As a result, their sabres had narrower blades than their British counterparts. This is an An XI model, introduced in 1802–03. The iron scabbard is tougher than earlier brass and leather examples.

Suspension ring

Curb bit

Bridle
All French light cavalry used the same tack – in black leather as opposed to the British light tan. The light cavalry used a combination of headcollar and double bridle. The bridle shown here is only part of the whole.

Curb chain

Reins

Plaited whip attached to reins

Flint clamp screw

Cock

Pan

Striking steel

Brassbound ramrod

Trigger at half cock

Flint wrapped in leather

Brass buttplate

Pair of pistols
In the chasseurs, the hussars, and the dragoons, whose functions within the army were broadly similar, officers, trumpeters, and NCOs usually carried a pair of flintlock pistols. These are a pair of dragoon's pistols of a late 18th-century model.

Pommel